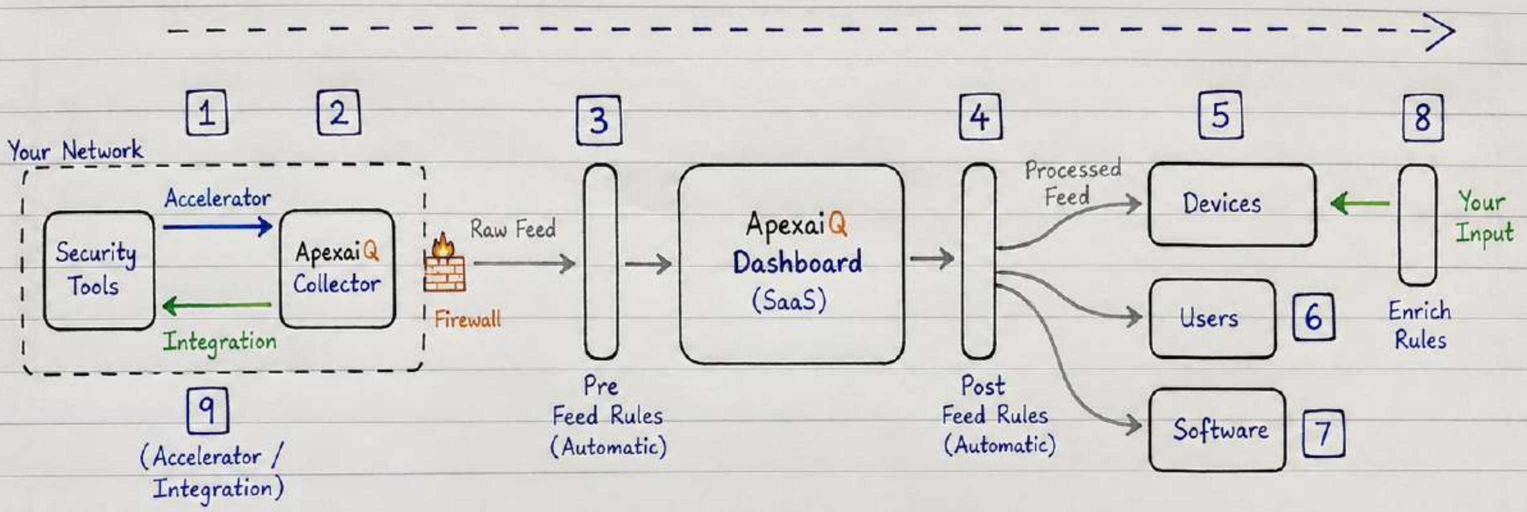
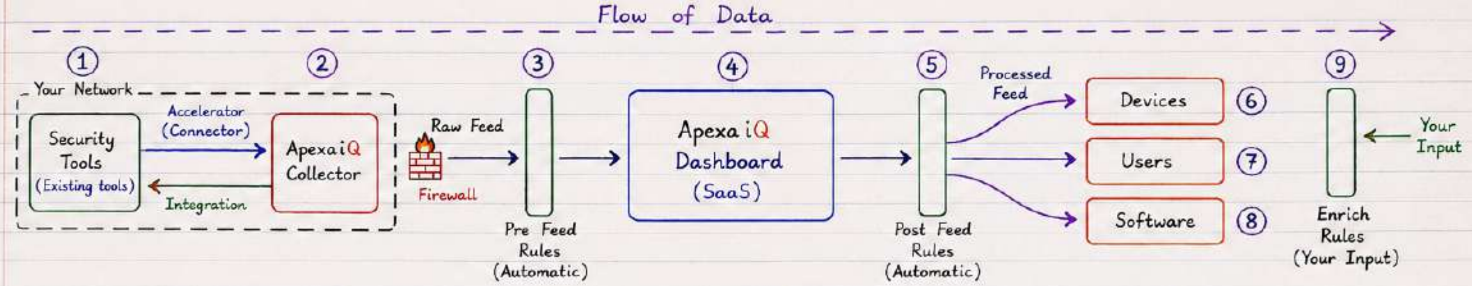
Flow of Data



1. Security Tools – Existing tools in your network (e.g. EDR, Vulnerability Scanner, AD, Cloud, Firewall, etc.).
2. ApexaiQ Collector – Collects data from these tools using Accelerators and integrations.
3. Pre Feed Rules – Cleans, validates and normalizes raw data before sending to the dashboard.
4. ApexaiQ Dashboard (SaaS) – Receives the clean data and processes it. All analysis, risk scoring, correlation happens here.
5. Devices – Inventory of all devices (discovery, details, risk, compliance etc.).
6. Users – Information about users and the devices they are using.
7. Software – Inventory of all software, versions, licenses, vulnerabilities etc.
8. Enrich Rules – Your input to add business context, tags, departments, criticality, owners etc.
9. Accelerator / Integration – Pre-built connectors that help the collector to quickly integrate with tools.

Apexa iQ – Complete Workflow (Flow of Data)

Apexa iQ is an agentless IT Asset Management & Security platform. It collects data from existing tools, processes it and shows meaningful insights in the dashboard.



1. Security Tools (Existing tools)
   - Tools like EDR, Vulnerability Scanner, AD, Cloud, Firewall, Patch tools, etc.
   - These tools already exist in your network and have data.

2. Accelerator (Connector)
   - Ready-made connectors (Accelerators) act as a bridge between ApexaiQ Collector and security tools.
   - You just provide URL, username, password or API key.
   - Accelerator handles authentication, API calls and communication.

3. ApexaiQ Collector
   - Installed in your environment (or cloud).
   - Uses Accelerators to connect with all tools.
   - Collects data from each tool.
   - Does not analyze, it only collects data.

4. Raw Feed
   - Collector sends collected data to ApexaiQ.
   - Data is raw, unprocessed, may have duplicates, different formats, inconsistencies.
   - Sent securely through firewall to cloud.

5. Pre Feed Rules (Automatic)
   - Data cleaning & normalization happens here.
   - Removes duplicates, fixes formats, standardizes names, fills blanks, validates data.
   - Converts data into a clean & consistent form.

6. ApexaiQ Dashboard (SaaS)
   - Clean data is stored and analyzed here.
   - Checks vulnerabilities, missing patches, end of support, compliance, maintenance, obsolescence. and many more.
   - Calculates risk, ApexaiQ Score and generates insights.

7. Post Feed Rules (Automatic)
   - After analysis, data is categorized and organized.
   - Dashboard decides where each data belongs.
   - Applies mapping and classification.
   - Routes data to correct modules like Devices, Users, Software.

8. Devices / Users / Software
   - Devices: All assets like laptops, desktops, servers, mobiles, printers, cloud instances.
   - Users: All users and mapping with devices they are using.
   - Software: All installed software, versions, licenses, vulnerabilities, missing patches.

9. Enrich Rules (Your Input)
   - Customer adds business context.
   - Example: Department, Owner, Criticality, Business Impact, Location, Tags, Cost Center, etc.
   - Helps in better analysis, reporting and decision making.

Example of Enrichment

Server01
- Department : Finance
- Owner : Ritesh
- Criticality : High
- Business Impact : Very High
- Location : Mumbai
- Cost Center : IT-Infra

Detailed Flow Explanation

1. Security Tools → Many tools have data about devices, users, software, vulnerabilities, etc.
2. Accelerator → Ready connector connects ApexaiQ Collector to each tool using API.
3. Collector → Pulls data from all tools using accelerators at regular intervals.
4. Raw Feed → Collected data (raw) is sent securely to ApexaiQ cloud.
5. Pre Feed Rules → Data is cleaned, duplicates removed, formats fixed, standardized.
6. Dashboard → Clean data is analyzed, correlated and enriched with global databases. Risk, compliance, maintenance, obsolescence and scores are calculated.
7. Post Feed Rules → Data is classified and routed to correct modules.
8. Devices / Users / Software → Information is available in separate modules.
9. Enrich Rules → Customer adds business context to make data more meaningful.

Benefit of this Workflow

- Centralized view of all assets, users and software.
- Accurate data due to cleaning and normalization.
- Better risk assessment and compliance.
- Easy reporting and actionable insights.
- Customer adds business context for better decision making.

In Simple Words

Existing Tools → Accelerator → Collector → Raw Feed → Pre Feed Rules → Dashboard (Analysis) → Post Feed Rules → Devices / Users / Software → Enrich Rules (Your Input) → Better Insights & Actionable Reports.

1. Security Tools (Existing Tools)

→ What are Security Tools?

Security tools are software or platforms that help an organization protect, monitor and manage its IT assets, users and data. They collect important information from different areas of the IT environment.

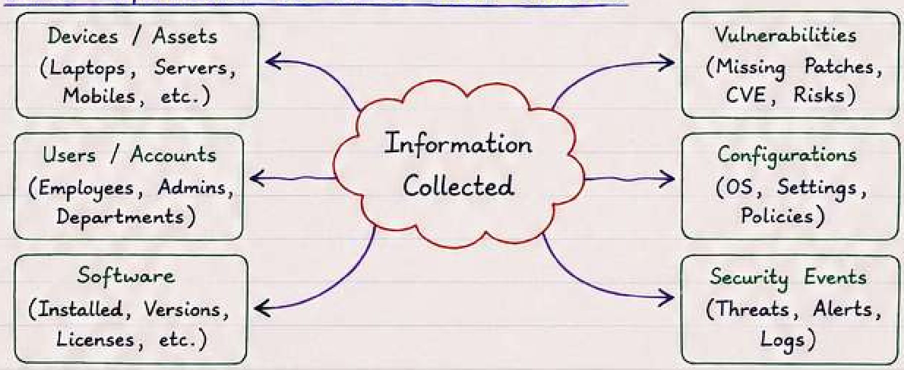
→ Why Security Tools are Important?

- They give visibility of all devices, users and software.
- They detect threats, vulnerabilities and risks.
- They help in compliance, patch management and security monitoring.
- ApexaiQ uses data from these tools to create a complete picture of the IT environment.

→ Common Security Tools Used in an Organization

Sr. No.	Security Tool	What it does	Type of Information Collected
1.	Microsoft Defender for Endpoint	Antivirus, EDR, threat detection and protection for endpoints.	• Device name, OS, IP address • Antivirus status, last scan • Threats detected, quarantined files • Firewall status, real-time protection
2.	Qualys	Vulnerability management and compliance scanning.	• Vulnerabilities (CVE IDs) • Missing patches • System configuration • Compliance status
3.	Active Directory	User management and authentication service.	• User name, department • Computer mapped to user • Login time, last logon • Groups and roles
4.	VMware vCenter	Virtualization management platform.	• Virtual machines list • CPU, RAM, Storage details • VM status, power state • Host server information
5.	AWS (Amazon Web Seriectes)	Cloud infrastructure and service management.	• EC2 instances, S3 buckets • IAM users and roles • Security groups, VPCs • Configuration and usage details
6.	Others (e.g. CrowdStrike, Palo Alto, ServiceNow)	Provide security, network and ITSM related data.	• Alerts, incidents, assets • Network logs, firewall logs • Tickets, change requests

→ What Information do These Tools Collect?



Note: Each tool collects data from its own area. ApexaiQ combines data from all these tools to give one single, complete and accurate view in the dashboard.

→ Real-Life Example

Suppose a laptop (Laptop101) is in the company.

- Microsoft Defender will tell → It has antivirus installed, system is healthy.
- Qualys will tell → It is missing 5 critical patches.
- Active Directory will tell → This laptop is used by Rahul from Finance department.
- VMware will tell → It is not a virtual machine (Physical device).
- AWS will tell → It is not running in cloud.

ApexaiQ takes all this information together and shows in one dashboard.

In short → Security Tools are the data sources. ApexaiQ uses their data to analyze, manage and secure the IT environment.

2. ApexaiQ Collector

→ What is ApexaiQ Collector ?

ApexaiQ Collector is a lightweight application/agent that is installed inside the customer network. Its main job is to collect data from all integrated tools and send it securely to the ApexaiQ cloud (SaaS platform).

Key Point

- Collector does not store data permanently.
- It only collects and sends the data.
- It acts as a bridge between security tools and ApexaiQ dashboard.

→ Where is the Collector Installed ?

- Collector is installed inside the customer's network (on a server or VM).
- It should have connectivity to all security tools and internet access (https 443) to send data to ApexaiQ cloud.

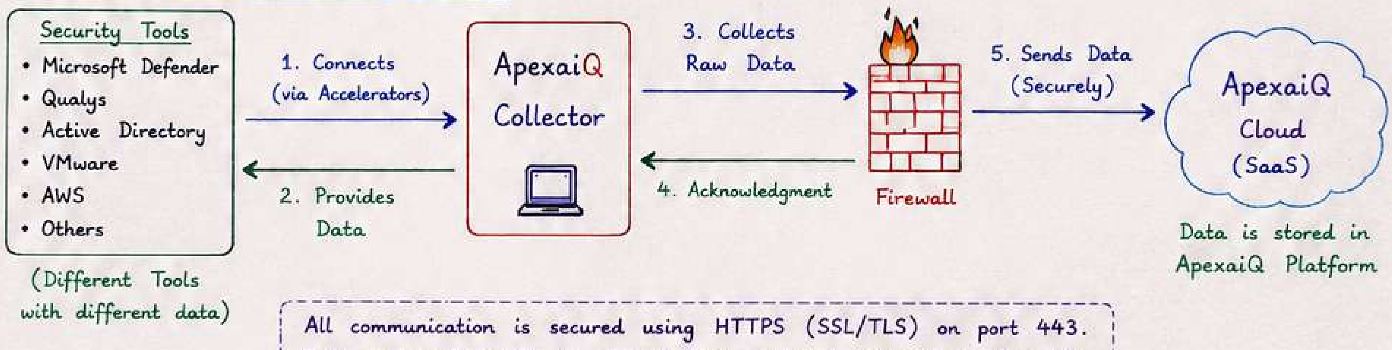
→ What does Collector do ? (Functions)

1. Connects to all integrated security tools using Accelerators (via APIs).
2. Pulls data at regular intervals (configurable).
3. Collects raw data as different tools provide.
4. Encrypts the data.
5. Sends data securely to ApexaiQ cloud through firewall.
6. Runs in background as a service.

Collector Characteristics

- Lightweight
- Secure
- Runs as a service
- Configurable
- Fault tolerant (auto retry)
- No local data storage

→ How Collector Works ? (Flow)



All communication is secured using HTTPS (SSL/TLS) on port 443.
Only outbound traffic is allowed from customer network to ApexaiQ.

→ What type of data Collector collects ?

- Devices / Assets information
- Users / Accounts information
- Software / Applications information
- Vulnerabilities and Patches
- Configurations
- Security Events / Alerts
- License and Compliance information (depends on the tool)

→ Example

Collector connects to Microsoft Defender using Defender Accelerator.

1. Authenticates using API Key.
2. Calls API to get devices list.
3. Gets antivirus status, threats, last scan time etc.
4. Collects the data in raw format.
5. Sends to ApexaiQ cloud.

→ Security of Data

- Data is encrypted before sending.
- Uses TLS 1.2 or higher.
- Only outbound connection (443).
- Credentials are stored in encrypted format.
- No data is stored permanently on Collector machine.

→ Collector Configuration

- Admin installs Collector using installation package.
- Provides ApexaiQ Server URL and API Key.
- Adds all tools using Accelerators (with required credentials).
- Sets collection frequency (e.g. every 15 min / 1 hour / daily).
- Starts the Collector service.
- Monitor status from Collector UI or ApexaiQ dashboard.

→ Benefits

- Centralized data collection from all tools.
- No manual work required.
- Real-time or near real-time data.
- Secure and reliable data transfer.
- Saves time and effort.

In Short

ApexaiQ Collector is like a data collector agent. It sits inside the customer network, connects to all tools using Accelerators, collects raw data, encrypts it and sends it securely to ApexaiQ cloud for processing and analysis.

3. Raw Feed (Unprocessed Data)

→ What is Raw Feed ?

Raw Feed is the unprocessed data that is collected by the Collector from all the integrated security tools. It is in its original format as provided by the tools, without any modification, cleaning or standardization.

It is simply the "as is" data sent from Collector to ApexaiQ cloud.

Key Point

- Raw Feed is the first form of data received by ApexaiQ.
- It may contain duplicates, inconsistent formats, different naming, missing values, etc.
- Raw Feed is required so that no information is lost at this stage.

→ How Raw Feed is Generated ?

1. Collector connects to all tools using Accelerators.
2. Each tool sends its data in its own format.
3. Collector collects all this data.
4. Without changing anything, it packs the data.
5. This packed data is called Raw Feed.
6. Raw Feed is then sent to ApexaiQ cloud through firewall securely.

→ Example of Raw Feed Data

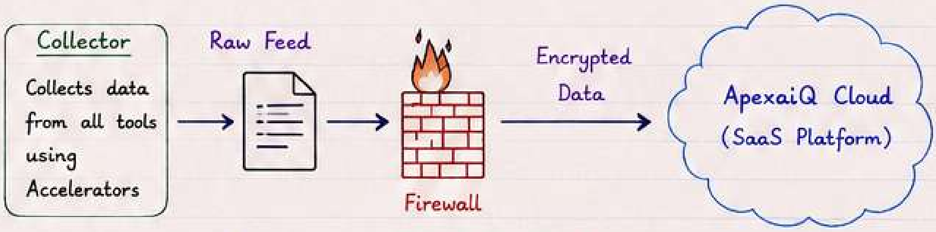
Tool	Device Name	OS	User	Vulnerability	IP Address
Defender	LAPTOP101	Windows11	RAHUL	No Threat	192.168.1.2
Qualys	laptop-101	windows 11	rahul.sharma	CVE-2025-1234	192.168.1.2
AD	Laptop101	Win 11	Rahul Sharma	–	192.168.1.2
VMware	VM-L101	–	–	–	192.168.1.2

(Same device but different format, naming, case, etc.)

→ Characteristics of Raw Feed

- Unprocessed
- Contains duplicates
- Inconsistent formats
- Different naming conventions
- Missing or null values
- Tool-specific structure
- Large volume of data

→ How Raw Feed is Sent to Cloud ?



All data is transferred using HTTPS (SSL/TLS) on port 443.
Only outbound traffic is allowed from customer network.

→ What Does Raw Feed Contain ?

- Devices / Assets data (name, IP, OS, MAC, etc.)
- Users / Accounts data (username, login time, department, etc.)
- Vulnerabilities / Patches data (CVE, severity, status, etc.)
- Configuration data (settings, policies, status, etc.)
- Software data (installed software, version, license, etc.)
- Security events / alerts (detections, threats, logs, etc.)

→ Purpose of Raw Feed

1. To capture complete data without any loss.
2. To store original data for reference.
3. To allow further cleaning and processing in next steps (Pre Feed Rules).
4. To maintain data integrity.

→ Example – Before Cleaning (Raw Feed)

Device Name	:	LAPTOP101 / laptop-101 / Laptop101 / LAPTOP 101
OS	:	Windows11 / windows 11 / Win 11 / WINDOWS 11
User	:	rahul / Rahul Sharma / RAHUL.SHARMA / rahul.sharma
IP	:	192.168.1.2 / 192.168.001.002 / 192.168.1.2
Vulnerability	:	cve-2025-1234 / CVE-2025-1234 / – / CvE-2025-1234

Note :
Raw Feed is like "unfiltered data". It will be cleaned, normalized and validated in the next step (Pre Feed Rules).

In Short

Raw Feed is the unprocessed data collected by the Collector from all integrated tools. It contains duplicates, different formats, inconsistent values, etc. This raw data is sent securely to ApexaiQ cloud. In the next step, it will be cleaned and prepared using Pre Feed Rules.

4. Pre Feed Rules (Automatic)

→ What are Pre Feed Rules ?

Pre Feed Rules are a set of automatic processes applied on Raw Feed data before sending it to the ApexaiQ Dashboard. These rules clean, validate, normalize and standardize the data to make it accurate, consistent and ready for analysis.

Key Point

- Applied automatically.
- Improves data quality.
- Removes junk, duplicates and errors.
- Ensures consistency.
- Prepares data for meaningful analysis.

→ Why Pre Feed Rules are Important ?

- Raw data from different tools may be unorganized and inconsistent.
- If we send raw data directly to dashboard, reports will be wrong.
- Pre Feed Rules improve data quality and reduce processing load.
- It helps in accurate risk calculation and reporting.

→ Pre Feed Rules – Main Activities

1. Data Cleaning – Removes unwanted data like duplicates, null values, corrupted records etc.
   Example : Duplicate device entry removed.
2. Normalization – Converts data into a standard format.
   Example : OS name "Win 11", "Windows11" and "windows 11" → Windows 11
3. Standardization – Makes naming and formats consistent.
   Example : IP "192.168.001.002" → 192.168.1.2
4. Validation – Checks if data is in valid format and within allowed values.
   Example : Invalid IP or date format removed.
5. De-duplication – Removes duplicate records based on rules like device name + IP + MAC.
   Example : Same device reported by two tools → One record kept.
6. Data Enrichment (Basic) Adds basic missing info if available like device type, OS version etc.
   Example : If OS version missing, it is fetched from another field.

Flow of Pre Feed Rules

Raw Feed Data
(Unprocessed Data from Collector)

↓

1. Data Cleaning
(Remove duplicates, nulls, corrupted data)

↓

2. Normalization
(Convert to standard format)

↓

3. Standardization
(Consistent naming & formatting)

↓

4. Validation
(Check valid formats and values)

↓

5. De-duplication
(Remove duplicate records)

↓

Clean & Standardized Data
Ready to send to ApexaiQ Dashboard

→ Example – Before and After Pre Feed Rules

Before Pre Feed Rules (Raw Feed)	After Pre Feed Rules (Clean Data)
Device Name : LAPTOP101	Device Name : LAPTOP101
OS : Win 11	OS : Windows 11
IP Address : 192.168.001.002	IP Address : 192.168.1.2
User : rahul	User : Rahul
OS : windows 11	
IP Address : 192.168.1.2	Note : Clean, consistent and duplicate removed
User : RAHUL	
Note : Duplicate & inconsistent data	

Pre Feed Rules Handle

- Inconsistent naming
- Missing values
- Duplicate records
- Wrong formats
- Extra spaces, special characters
- Case sensitivity issues
- Wrong or invalid data
- Tool specific structure

In Short

Pre Feed Rules are automatic data preparation steps that clean, normalize, validate and standardize Raw Feed data. This ensures that only high quality, accurate and consistent information is sent to ApexaiQ Dashboard for analysis and reporting.

5. ApexaiQ Dashboard (SaaS Platform)

→ What is ApexaiQ Dashboard ?

ApexaiQ Dashboard is a cloud based (SaaS) platform where all the data collected from different tools is stored, processed, analyzed and presented in a meaningful way. It gives complete visibility of your IT environment and helps in better security and asset management.

Key Points

- It is a SaaS (Software as a Service) platform.
- All heavy processing is done in the cloud.
- Provides real-time or near real-time insights.
- Data is secure, encrypted and available anytime from anywhere.
- Helps in better decision making and risk reduction.

→ Main Functions / Activities of Dashboard

1. Data Storage – All cleaned and standardized data is stored securely in cloud.
2. Data Processing – Data is indexed and processed for fast search and analysis.
3. Vulnerability Analysis – Finds missing patches, misconfigurations, software vulnerabilitis and security risks.
4. Compliance Check – Checks against various compliance standards (like ISO, PCI-DSS, etc.) and shows compliance status.
5. Obsolescence Management – Identifies End of Life (EOL) products, unsupported software/hardware.
6. Maintenance Management – Tracks warranty, support and maintenance status of assets.
7. ApexaiQ Score – Calculates a risk score (ApexaiQ Score) for each asset based on vulnerabilities, compliance, obsolescence and other factors.
8. Reporting & Alerts – Generates dashboards, reports, and alerts for critical issues and changes.

How Dashboard Works (Inside)

1. **Data Ingestion** – Clean & standardized data is received from Pre Feed Rules.

↓

2. **Data Processing** – Data is indexed, correlated and organized in database.

↓

3. **Analysis Engine** – Vulnerability scan, compliance check, obsolescence check and risk calculation.

↓

4. **Calculation Engine** – ApexaiQ Score is calculated for each asset.

↓

5. **Reports & Dashboards** – Insights, graphs, trends and reports are generated.

↓

6. **Alerts & Notifications** – Critical issues and changes trigger alerts and notifications.

→ What kind of data is processed in Dashboard ?

- Assets (Devices, Servers, Laptops, Network devices, etc.)
- Users and Accounts
- Installed Software and Applications
- Vulnerabilities and Missing Patches
- Configuration and Security Settings
- License and Compliance Information
- Security Events and Alerts
- Warranty and Maintenance Information

→ Benefits of ApexaiQ Dashboard

- Centralized view of all IT assets and risks.
- Easy to understand dashboards and reports.
- Real-time monitoring and risk assessment.
- Helps in compliance and audit readiness.
- Reduces security risks and vulnerabilities.
- Saves time and manual effort.
- Improves decision making.

→ Example

Asset (Device)	Dashboard Shows
LAPTOP101	• Missing 5 critical patches • OS : Windows 11 • ApexaiQ Score : 650/1000 • Compliance : 70% • Warranty : Valid till 15-Jan-2026 • Risk Level : High
SERVER01	• No major vulnerabilities • OS : Windows Server 2019 • ApexaiQ Score : 850/1000 • Compliance : 95% • Warranty : Valid till 20-Mar-2026 • Risk Level : Medium
SW-APP01	• Software : Adobe Reader • Version : 9.0 (End of Life) • Obsolescence : Yes • Risk Level : High

In Short

ApexaiQ Dashboard (SaaS) is the heart of the platform. It stores, processes, analyzes and converts clean data into meaningful insights, scores, reports and alerts to help organizations manage their IT assets and security risks effectively.

6. Post Feed Rules (Automatic)

→ What are Post Feed Rules ?

Post Feed Rules are a set of automatic rules applied on the processed data inside ApexaiQ Dashboard after all analysis is done.

These rules organize and classify the data into meaningful groups like Devices, Users and Software.

Key Points

- Applied after data is processed in dashboard.
- Organizes data into meaningful inventory.
- Creates relationships between different asset types.
- Makes data easy to understand and use.
- Prepares data for customer enrichment (your input).

→ Why Post Feed Rules are Important ?

- Raw data and processed data may contain many tables and records.
- Without classification, it is difficult to understand and use.
- Post Feed Rules structure the data and map relationships.
- It helps in asset inventory, risk mapping and reporting.

Flow of Post Feed Rules

Processed & Analyzed Data (From Dashboard)

↓

Post Feed Rules Engine

↓

Devices (Inventory) | Users (Accounts) | Software (Inventory)

↓

Structured Data (Ready for Enrichment)

Main Activities of Post Feed Rules

1. Data Classification – Group data into Devices, Users and Software.
2. Relationship Mapping – Map relationships between devices, users and software.
3. Deduplication (Advanced) – Remove any remaining duplicates.
4. Normalization (Advanced) – Ensure data is in final standard format.
5. Enrichment Preparation – Prepare data for customer enrichment (your input).

→ How Post Feed Rules Work ?

1. Takes processed data from Dashboard.
2. Applies mapping and classification rules.
3. Identifies unique devices, users and software.
4. Maps relationships (e.g., which user uses which device, which software is installed on which device).
5. Produces structured and clean inventory.
6. Sends structured data for enrichment (your input).

→ Example – Mapping Relationships

Device Name	User	Installed Software	IP Address
LAPTOP101	Rahul Sharma	Microsoft Office	192.168.1.2
LAPTOP101	Rahul Sharma	Adobe Reader	192.168.1.2
SERVER01	Admin	Windows Server	192.168.1.10
SERVER01	Admin	SQL Server	192.168.1.10

Post Feed Rules will group and map this data as → Devices, Users and Software with proper relationships.

→ What Do We Get After Post Feed Rules ?

1. Devices (Inventory)

- Unique device list
- Device details (IP, OS, Type, Location etc.)
- Hardware information
- Network information
- Device status

2. Users (Accounts)

- Unique user list
- User details (Name, Department, Role etc.)
- Devices used by user
- Last login, activity info

3. Software (Inventory)

- Installed software list
- Version information
- License information
- Missing patches
- Vulnerable software

→ Example – Before and After Post Feed Rules

Before Post Feed Rules (Processed Data)	After Post Feed Rules (Structured Data)
• Multiple tables and raw records • Hard to understand • Duplicate and inconsistent entries • No clear relationship • Example : 1000+ records in different tables	• Data is grouped into Devices, Users, Software • Duplicates removed • Relationships mapped • Clean and structured inventory • Example : 300 devices, 250 users, 1500 software records

Note : Post Feed Rules are very important because they convert complex processed data into simple, structured and useful inventory for better asset management, risk analysis and reporting.

In Short

Post Feed Rules take processed data from ApexaiQ Dashboard and automatically organize it into Devices, Users and Software with proper relationships. The output is clean, structured and ready for enrichment (your input) and final reporting.

7. Devices, Users and Software

→ What is it ?

After Post Feed Rules, the data is classified into three main asset types: Devices, Users and Software.

These are the core inventory items managed in ApexaiQ Dashboard.

Key Points

- These are the main output after data is structured and mapped.
- They form the complete IT asset inventory.
- Helps in visibility, management, risk analysis and reporting.

① Devices (Inventory)

Devices are all the physical or virtual assets connected to your network.

Includes :

- Laptops, Desktops, Servers
- Mobile Devices
- Network Devices (Switch, Router, Firewall)
- Virtual Machines, Cloud Instances

Information Collected :

- Device Name / Hostname
- IP Address
- OS and Version
- MAC Address
- Device Type
- Location / Department
- Last Seen / Status
- Installed Software Count
- Missing Patches Count
- Vulnerability Count

Example :

Device Name	:	LAPTOP101
IP Address	:	192.168.1.2
OS	:	Windows 11 Pro
Type	:	Laptop
Dever	:	Rahul Sharma
Department	:	IT
Status	:	Active
Missing Patches	:	5
Vulnerabilities	:	7 (High:2, Med:5)

② Users (Accounts)

Users are all the individuals or accounts who access and use IT resources.

Includes :

- Active Directory Users
- Local Users
- Service Accounts
- Cloud / Application Users

Information Collected :

- User Name / Login ID
- Full Name
- Department
- Role / Designation
- Last Login
- Account Status (Active/Inactive)
- Devices Used
- Access Level / Permissions

Example :

User Name	:	rahul.sharma
Full Name	:	Rahul Sharma
Department	:	IT
Role	:	System Admin
Last Login	:	14-May-2025 10:30 AM
Status	:	Active
Devices Used	:	LAPTOP101
Access Level	:	Admin

③ Software (Inventory)

Software includes all the applications and programs installed on devices.

Includes :

- Installed Software
- Software Versions
- License Information
- Missing Patches
- Vulnerable Software
- End of Life (EOL) Software

Information Collected :

- Software Name
- Version
- Publisher / Vendor
- Install Date
- License Status (Licensed / Unlicensed)
- Missing Patches
- Vulnerability / Risk Level
- End of Life Status

Example :

Software Name	:	Adobe Reader
Version	:	23.008.20421
Publisher	:	Adobe Inc.
License	:	Licensed
Install Date	:	10-Mar-2025
Missing Patches	:	2
Risk Level	:	Medium
EOL Status	:	No

→ How They Work Together ?

Devices — Shows where and what assets are present. → **Users** — Shows who is using which devices and resources. → **Software** — Shows what software is installed on those devices.

Example Scenario :

- Rahul (User) uses LAPTOP101 (Device).
- On that laptop, Microsoft Office and Adobe Reader (Software) are installed.
- Office is licensed and up-to-date.
- Adobe Reader has 2 missing patches and is vulnerable.

→ Benefits of This Step

- ☑ Complete visibility of IT assets.
- ☑ Helps in risk identification.
- ☑ Easy tracking of users and devices.
- ☑ Helps in license management.
- ☑ Supports compliance and audit.

In Short.

Devices, Users and Software are the three main asset categories created by Post Feed Rules. They provide a clear and organized view of your IT environment – what you have (Devices), who is using (Users) and what is installed (Software). This inventory is the base for risk analysis, compliance and better decision making.

8. Enrich Rules (Your Input)

→ What are Enrich Rules ?

Enrich Rules are the customer specific inputs added on top of the data already processed by ApexaiQ Dashboard.

These rules add business context to IT assets so that risks and priorities can be understood better.

Key Points

- Enrich Rules are added by customer (your input).
- They are not collected automatically.
- These rules include department, owner, criticality, tags, business impact, priority etc.
- They help in better risk analysis and management.
- They are used in reports, dashboards and alerts.

→ Why Enrich Rules are Important ?

- Adds business context to technical data.
- Helps in identifying critical assets.
- Improves risk prioritization.
- Helps in reporting and decision making.
- Makes data meaningful as per your organization.

Where are Enrich Rules Applied ?

Data from Dashboard (Devices, Users, Software) → Enrich Rules (Your Input) → Enriched Data (With Business Context) → Reports, Scores, Alerts & Better Decision Making

→ What Information Can You Add ?

1. Department – Which department the asset belongs to.
2. Owner – Who is responsible for the asset.
3. Criticality – How critical the asset is for business.
4. Tags / Category – Business tags or category for grouping.
5. Business Impact – Impact if the asset is down or affected.
6. Priority – Priority level for action or remediation.
7. Custom Fields – Any other information as per your need.

→ Example – Enrich Rules for a Device

Field	Example Value
Device Name	LAPTOP101
IP Address	192.168.1.2
Department	IT
Owner	Rahul Sharma
Criticality	High
Tags / Category	Employee Laptop, Production
Business Impact	High – Used for daily operations
Priority	P1 – Fix Immediately
Location	Mumbai Office
Cost Center	CC-IT-01
Additional Note	Used by Project Team

→ How Enrich Rules are Added ?

- Customer or admin goes to Enrich Rules module.
- Selects the asset type (Device / User / Software).
- Chooses the field to enrich (e.g., Department).
- Enters the value for that asset.
- Saves the rule.
- The data is now enriched and used in reports.

→ Example – Before and After Enrichment

Before Enrichment (From Dashboard)

Device Name	IP Address	OS	Vulnerability Count
LAPTOP101	192.168.1.2	Windows 11	7 (High: 2, Med: 5)

→

After Enrichment (Your Input Added)

Device Name	Department	Owner	Criticality	Business Impact	Priority
LAPTOP101	IT	Rahul Sharma	High	High – Daily Operations	P1 – Fix Immediately

→ Benefits of Enrich Rules

- ☑ Makes technical data meaningful in business context.
- ☑ Helps in quick identification of critical assets.
- ☑ Improves risk prioritization and action planning.
- ☑ Supports compliance and audit requirements.
- ☑ Better reporting and communication with management.

Note :

Enrich Rules are the most important step because it converts technical data into business valuable information.
Without enrichment, data is just a list.
With enrichment, data becomes insight !

In Short

Enrich Rules are your inputs that add business context to the processed data.
You add information like Department, Owner, Criticality, Tags, Business Impact and Priority.
This enriched data is then used for better risk analysis, reporting and decision making.

9A. Accelerator & Integration

→ What are Accelerator & Integration ?

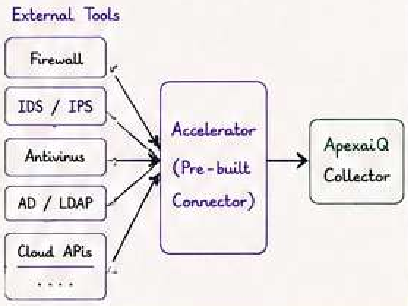
- Accelerator is a component that helps to connect data from different security tools to ApexaiQ Collector for faster and reliable data ingestion.
- Integration is the process of connecting and configuring different tools with ApexaiQ Collector using Accelerators.
- These help in seamless data flow and mapping.

Key Points

- Accelerators are pre-built connectors.
- They reduce configuration time and errors.
- Support secure and reliable data transfer.
- Integration ensures data is mapped in required format.
- Helps in better visibility, analysis and reporting.

→ Accelerator - Overview

- An Accelerator is a software component or service provided by ApexaiQ.
- It connects external tools with the Collector using API or log forwarding.
- It normalizes the data and sends it in ApexaiQ raw feed format.
- It acts as a bridge between the tool and ApexaiQ Collector.



→ Benefits of Accelerator

- ✓ Quickly connects many tools.
- ✓ Converts tool specific logs into standard format.
- ✓ Reduces manual work and errors.
- ✓ Ensures secure and reliable transfer.
- ✓ Provides high performance data ingestion.
- ✓ Easy to maintain and upgrade.

→ Integration - Overview

- Integration means connecting an external tool with ApexaiQ using Accelerator.
- It includes configuration, authentication, mapping and testing.
- After successful integration, data starts flowing to ApexaiQ Collector.

→ Steps in Integraton

1. Select the tool to be integrated.
2. Choose the appropriate Accelerator.
3. Configure connection (IP, Port, API Key, Credentials etc.).
4. Map fields as per ApexaiQ format.
5. Test the connection and data flow.
6. Enable the integration and monitor.

→ Differance - Accelerator vs Integration

Point	Accelerator	Integration
Meaning	Pre-built connector used to collect data from external tools.	Process of connecting and configuring tools with ApexaiQ using Accelerator.
Focus	Connects tool with Collector.	Configures, maps and enables the connection.
Scope	Technical component.	Complete end-to-end process.
Done By	Provided by ApexaiQ.	Done by Admin / User.
Output	Sends data in Raw Feed format.	Data is integrated and visible in dashboard.
Example	Windows Event Log Accelerator.	Integrating Windows Event Log using Accelerator.

→ End-to-End Flow (Using Accelerator & Integration)

(1) External Tool (e.g. Firewall) → (2) Accelerator (Pre-built Connector) → (3) ApexaiQ Collector (Raw Feed Format) → (4) Pre Feed Rules (Clean & Standardize) → (5) Post Feed Rules (Classify & Map) → (6) Devices, Users & Software (Inventory) → (7) ApexaiQ Dashboard (Insights & Reports)

→ Example - Integration of Windows Event Log

1. Select Tool : Windows Event Log
2. Choose Accelerator : Windows Event Log Accelerator
3. Configure Connection : IP = 10.1.1.5, Port = 5985, Protocol = WinRM, Credentials = Admin
4. Map Fields : Event ID → Event ID, User → Username, Time → Timestamp etc.
5. Test Connection : Verify data is coming to Collector.
6. Enable Integration : Integration is successful and data is visible in dashboard.

Sample Mapping

Tool Field	ApexaiQ Field
Event ID	Event ID
User	Username
Time Generated	Timestamp
Event Type	Event Type
Source IP	Source IP

In Short

Accelerator is the connector that brings data from tools to ApexaiQ Collector.
Integration is the process of configuring and mapping that data properly.
Together they ensure smooth, secure and accurate data flow for better visibility and decision making.

9. Complete Workflow (End-to-End)

→ What is the Complete Workflow ?

The complete workflow shows how data flows from different security tools to ApexaiQ Dashboard and finally becomes meaningful insights and reports after applying all the rules and customer inputs. It is an end-to-end process from data collection to final reporting.

Key Points

- It is a step-by-step flow of data.
- Raw data is collected, cleaned, analyzed and enriched.
- Data goes through multiple automatic and manual steps.
- Final output is used for risk analysis, compliance and decision making.

→ Workflow Flow (End-to-End)

(1) Security Tools (Existing Tools) → (2) Accelerator & Integration → (3) ApexaiQ Collector → (4) Raw Feed → (5) Pre Feed Rules → (6) ApexaiQ Dashboard (SaaS) → (7) Post Feed Rules → (8) Devices, Users & Software → (9) Enrich Rules (Your Input)

→ Description of Each Step in Workflow

Step	Step Name	What Happens ?	Output / Result
1	Security Tools (Existing Tools)	Different security tools like Microsoft Defender, Qualys, Active Directory, VMware, AWS, etc. collect data from the IT environment.	Raw data is available in each tool.
2	Accelerator & Integration	Collector uses Accelerators (ready-made connectors) to integrate with these tools through APIs. Data is mapped as per required format.	Connected tools and ready for data collection.
3	ApexaiQ Collector	Collector is installed inside customer network. It securely collects data from all integrated tools.	Data is collected from all sources.
4	Raw Feed	Collector sends the collected raw data through firewall to ApexaiQ cloud in Raw Feed format.	Unprocessed raw data received in cloud.
5	Pre Feed Rules	Automatic rules clean the raw data – remove duplicates, normalize, validate and standardize it.	Clean, consistent and standardized data.
6	ApexaiQ Dashboard (SaaS)	Dashboard processes the clean data – performs analysis, risk calculation, compliance check, obsolescence and maintenance tracking.	Analyzed data, scores, vulnerabilities and insights generated.
7	Post Feed Rules	Dashboard applies rules to organize data into Devices, Users and Software and map relationships.	Structured data with proper classification.
8	Devices, Users & Software	Complete inventory of devices, users and software is created. Missing patches, licenses, vulnerabilities and other details are identified.	Complete IT asset inventory with all details.
9	Enrich Rules (Your Input)	Customer adds business context using Enrich Rules like department, owner, criticality, tags, impact, priority etc.	Enriched data with business context for better risk analysis and reporting.

→ Final Output of Complete Workflow

- ✓ Real-time visibility of all IT assets.
- ✓ Vulnerability assessment and risk scoring.
- ✓ Compliance status and license management.
- ✓ Obsolescence and maintenance tracking.
- ✓ Business context added for better prioritization.
- ✓ Reports, dashboards and alerts for decision making.

→

Result :

Accurate insights, better risk management, faster decision making and improved security posture for the organization.

In Short

The complete workflow connects all the steps together – from collecting data from tools to generating meaningful reports. Each step adds value to the data and prepares it for final use.
This end-to-end process helps organizations manage their IT assets, reduce risks and stay compliant.